How to Record a Video Demonstration

CST1500 Computer Systems Architecture and Operating Systems

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Content of Video

- The video should be quick and to the point.
- Recommended:
  - Say your name and student number.
  - Say the SOB number.
  - Run the code, script or carry out the operations as required by the SOB
  - Show the output according to the requirement of the SOB.
- Bear in mind that you would not have lots of time in the lab to do the demonstration.
- **DO NOT present the code line by line. Give a general overview.**

Recording a Video Demonstration

- Record your video demonstration with a desktop screen recorder.
- **Do Not point your phone at the screen and record!**
- A desktop screen recorder records your screen and audio and saves them to a video file.
- If you are not familiar with screen recorders, I recommend that you use OBS Studio:
  - Free
  - Stable
  - Flexible
  - Works on all operating systems
- Available at: https://obsproject.com/

Practice Before Recording

- You must practice your demonstration before recording it.
- You need to learn how to work around the limitations of your system and show it to best advantage.
- This will enable you to present your project in a professional manner.
- Will help you to keep your presentation within the time limit.
- You should also watch your presentation before you submit it to check that the video works and that you are happy with it.
- **Do Not record demonstration 5 minutes before the deadline!**

Video File Size

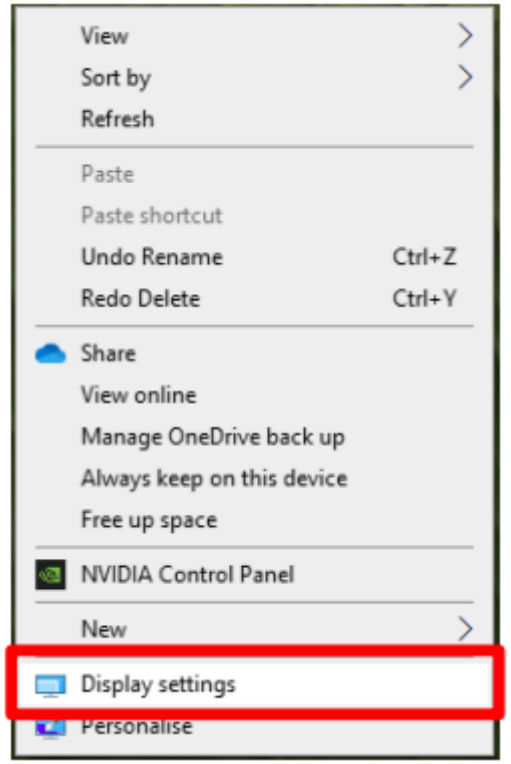
- The size of a video file is a combination of two factors:
  - **Resolution**. Number of pixels in each frame of video.
  - **Bitrate**. Amount of compression.
- Recommended:
  - **Resolution**: 1280 x 1024.
  - **Bitrate**: 2500 Kbps.
- This provides decent quality and a reasonable file size (approximately 20mb for 5 minutes).

Video Format

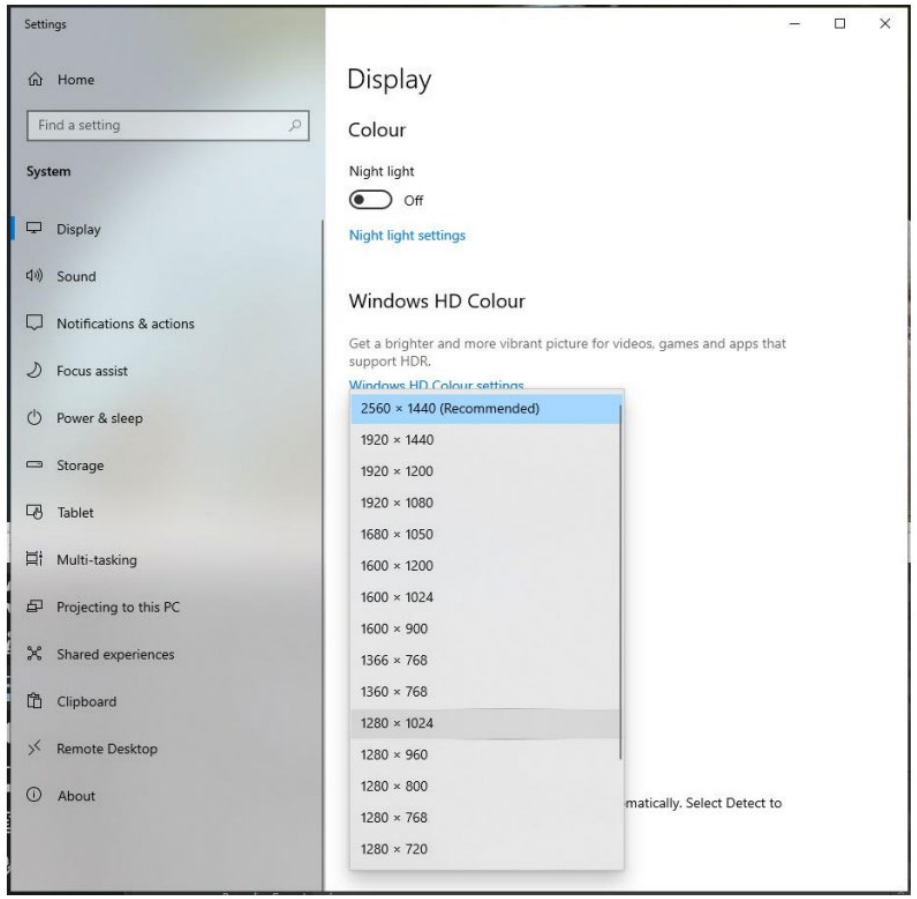
- Your video demonstration must be playable on the VLC player: https://www.videolan.org/vlc/index.en-GB.html
- If the video cannot be played by the tutor marking your work, that is **your** responsibility and **you** will lose marks.
- **To ensure that your video demonstration can be played, I strongly recommend that you record it in MP4 format.**

Reduce Screen Resolution

- If you are working on a high resolution display, you can reduce the screen resolution to reduce the file size of your video demonstration.
- Alternatively, you can scale down the video resolution in OBS studio.
- In Windows, right click the desktop and select Display Settings.



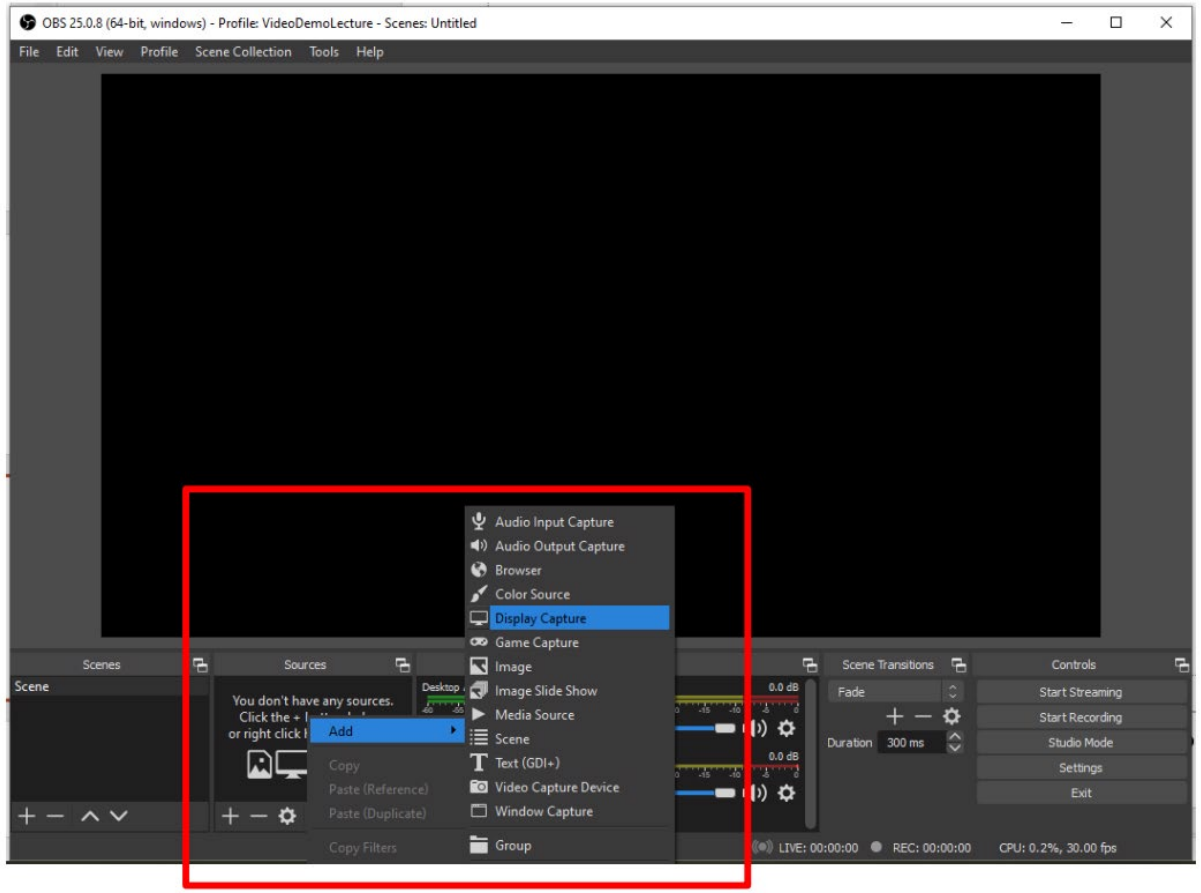
Set Screen Resolution



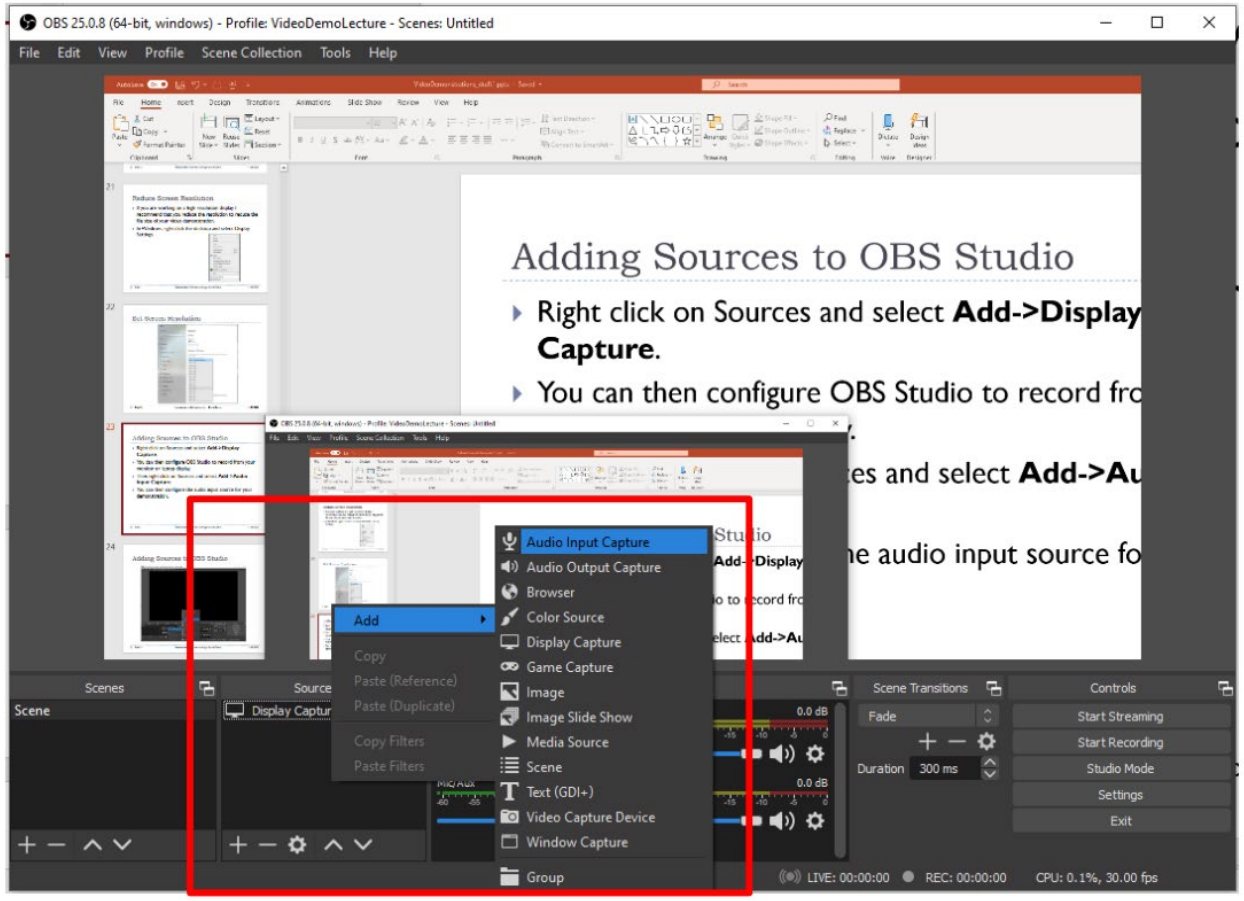
Adding Sources to OBS Studio

- Before you record, you need to configure the sources in OBS Studio.
- Right click on Sources and select Add->Display Capture.
- You can then configure OBS Studio to record from your monitor or laptop display.
- Right click on Sources and select Add->Audio Input Capture.
- You can then configure the audio input source for your demonstration.

Adding Display Capture to OBS Studio



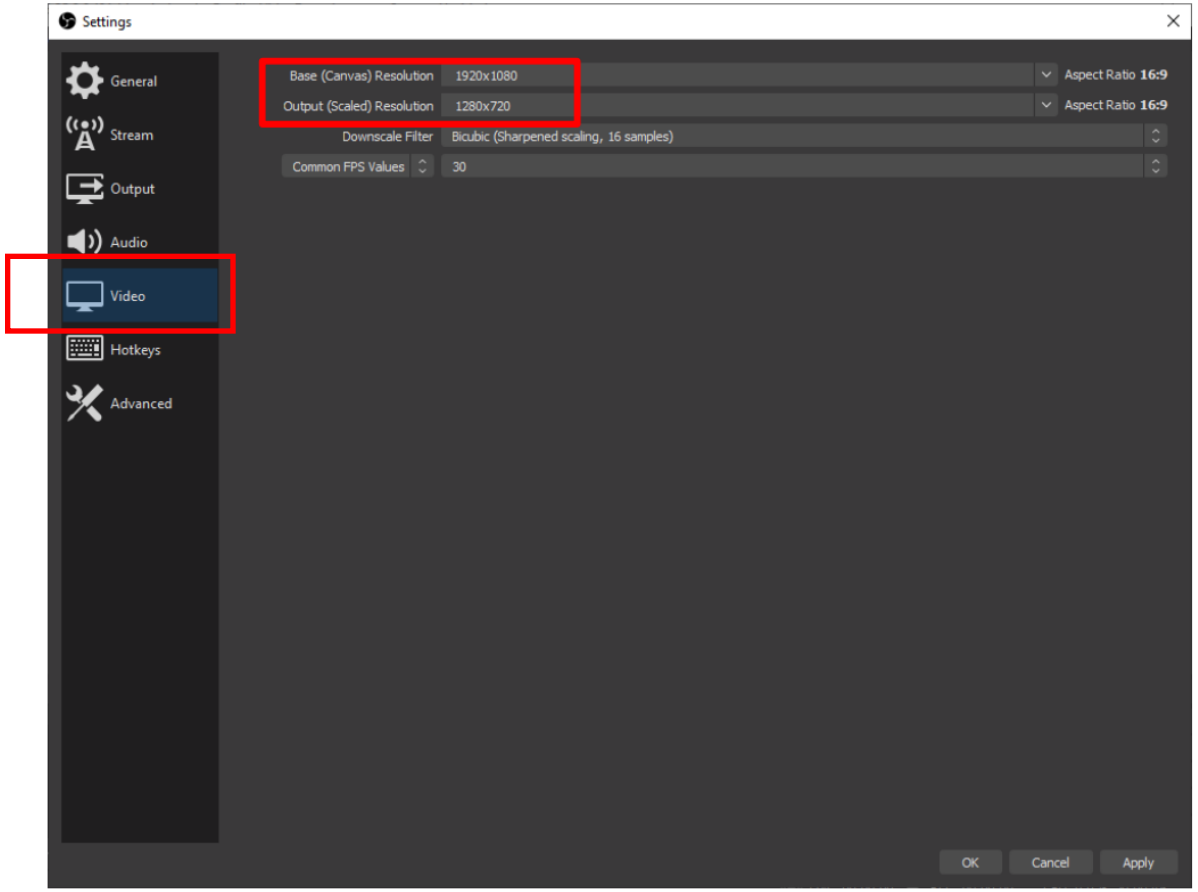
Adding Audio Source to OBS Studio



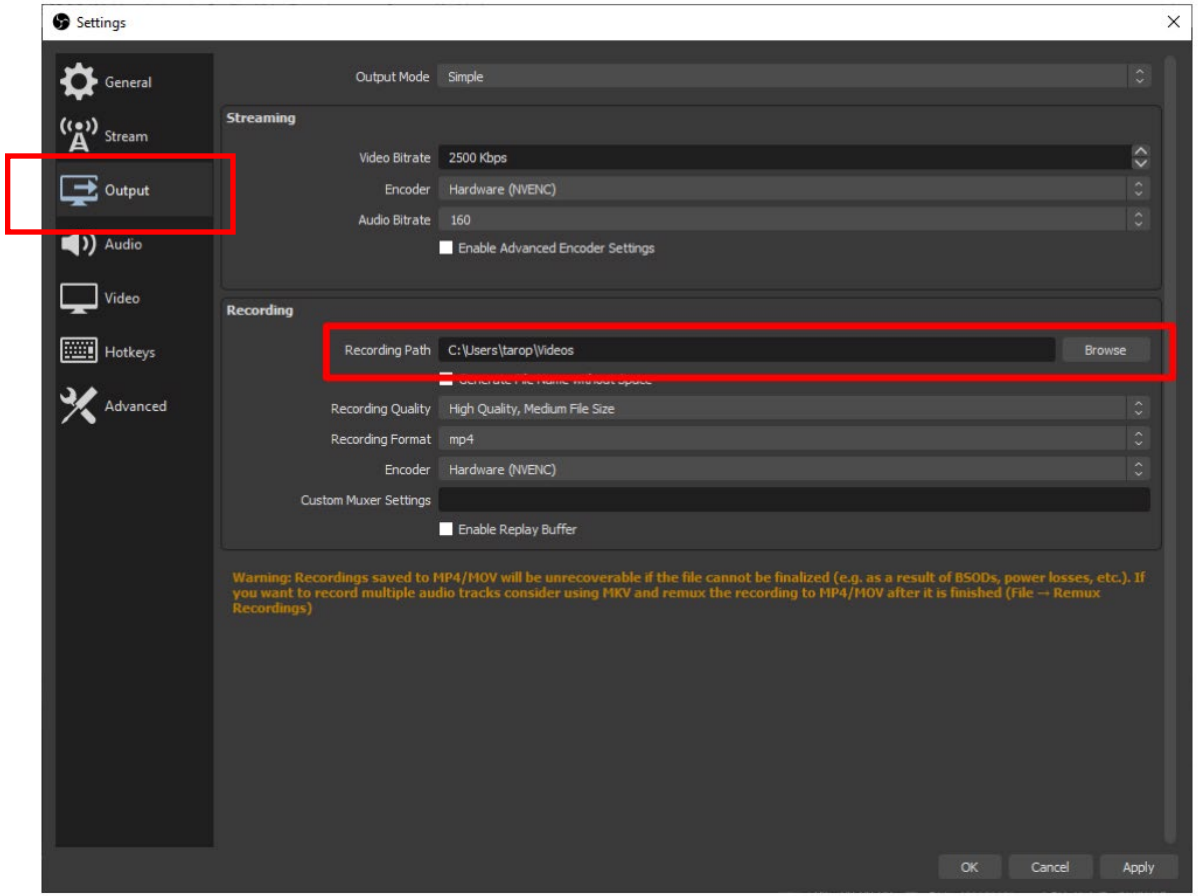
Configuration

- Click on Settings to set:
  - Location where video is stored.
  - Video resolution.
  - Video quality and bitrate.
  - Video format.

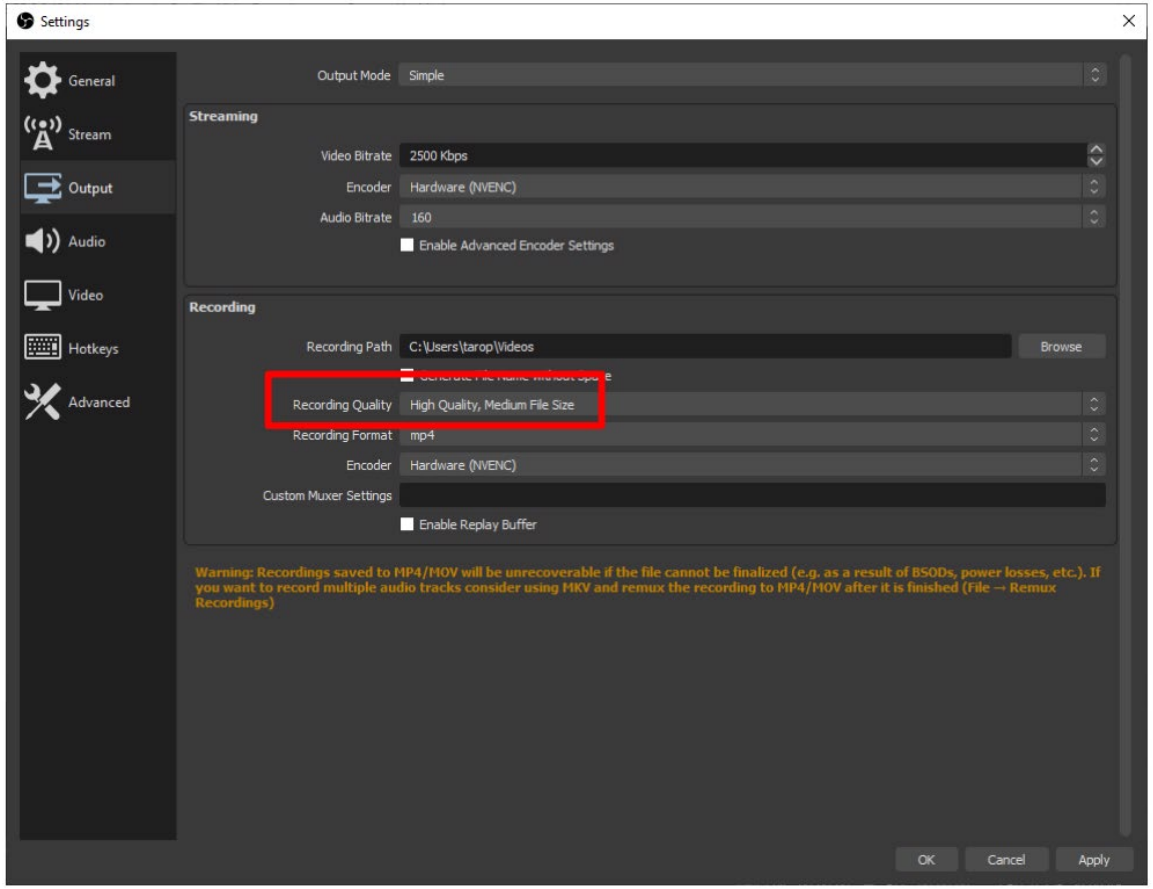
Video Setting



Output Settings



Output Settings



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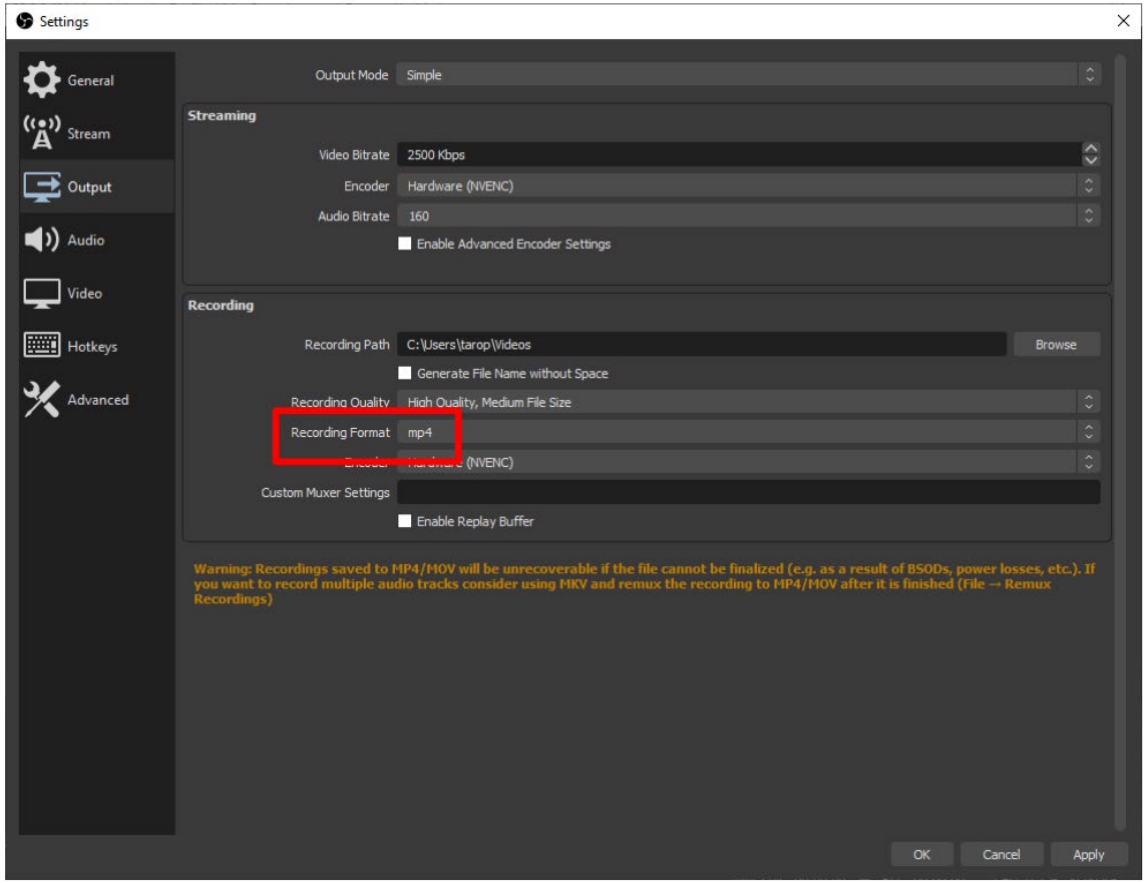

Recording

- Click ‘Start Recording’ to record your video.
- Do a test run to make sure that the sound is audible and the video is ok.
- Then you are ready to record your video demonstration.